IAM HOME LAB PORTFOLIO

Lab 03

Employee Offboarding & Full Access Revocation

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github.com/okpe027/ https://github.com/okpe027/IAM-HomeLab-Portfolio

Lab	Lab 03 of 20 — Phase 1 (Active Directory & On-Prem Identity)
Completed	April 15, 2026
Environment	VMware Workstation • Windows Server 2022 • Active Directory
What I did	Processed 3 termination tickets, built a production offboarding checklist, and documented the hybrid sync gap security risk
Tickets	TERM-0001 (standard resignation), TERM-0002 (for-cause urgent), TERM-0003 (contractor expiry)
Legal hold	Applied to p.sharma — for-cause termination — 90 days
Builds on	Lab 01 (user accounts and OUs) and Lab 02 (RBAC groups and role matrix)

1. What This Lab Is About

Offboarding is probably the most stressful task an IAM analyst handles day to day. Unlike provisioning where you have time to double-check everything, terminations often arrive with no warning — sometimes from HR at 4:45 PM on a Friday, sometimes as an urgent Slack message from a manager, and occasionally as a CISO calling you directly because someone just got walked out of the building.

The stakes are high. A missed offboarding step is the number one cause of audit findings, and it only takes one ex-employee with lingering access to cause a serious security incident. This lab puts you through three different termination scenarios so you understand not just the technical steps but the judgment calls that come with each type.

By the end of this lab I had:

- Processed a standard voluntary resignation from start to close

- Handled an urgent for-cause termination with legal hold and IT Security escalation
- Cleaned up a contractor account after automatic expiry
- Built a production offboarding checklist I can take into any IAM role
- Documented a hybrid sync gap that most candidates don't even know exists

2. The Lab Environment

This lab runs on the same FictionalCorp.local domain built in Lab 01 and expanded in Lab 02. All the users I'm offboarding in this lab were provisioned in those earlier labs, so the context carries through.

DC01 is my Windows Server 2022 Domain Controller running at 192.168.10.10 on VMware Workstation. The **Disabled_Users** OU I created in Lab 01 finally gets used here — that's where terminated accounts live until they're ready for deletion.

> **ONE THING TO NOTE ABOUT AZURE**
> This lab is purely on-premises. Azure comes into the picture in Lab 05 when I configure Azure AD Connect to sync FictionalCorp.local to Entra ID. But even here in Lab 03, I've documented a critical security gap that hybrid environments create — the 30-minute sync delay between AD and Entra ID. I'll close that gap in Lab 07.

3. The Termination Tickets

I work from tickets. Every IAM action I take is traceable to a documented request with an approval chain. This isn't just good practice — it's what auditors look for. If you can't show a ticket, the action didn't happen as far as compliance is concerned.

Three tickets came in during this lab. They're very different from each other, and each one taught me something important.

TERM-0001 — Fatima Al-Hassan — Standard Resignation

This is the most common type of termination ticket. Fatima resigned voluntarily from her Sales Representative role. Standard process, standard timeline, no complications.

```
TICKET #:      TERM-0001
```

```
Priority:      Standard
Date:          April 15, 2026
Requested by:  Sarah Johnson (HR Manager)
Approved by:   James Carter (IT Director)

Employee:      Fatima Al-Hassan  |  Username: f.alhassan
Department:    Sales  |  Role: Sales Representative
Last day:      April 15, 2026  |  Reason: Voluntary resignation

Access to revoke: AD account, GRP-Sales-Reps, SalesPro CRM, Email
Legal hold: No  |  Retention: 30 days then delete
```

TERM-0002 — Priya Sharma — For-Cause Termination

This one is a completely different situation. Priya was an HR Coordinator terminated for a policy violation. For-cause terminations require a different mindset entirely. Speed is critical, but so is protecting the organization legally. The standard offboarding checklist doesn't cover it — you need an escalation layer on top.

```
TICKET #:      TERM-0002
Priority:      IMMEDIATE — URGENT
Date:          April 15, 2026
Requested by:  James Carter (IT Director)
Approved by:   CISO (verbal approval confirmed)

Employee:      Priya Sharma  |  Username: p.sharma
Department:    HR  |  Role: HR Coordinator
Effective:     April 15, 2026 — immediately
Reason:        Policy violation — confidential

Access to revoke: ALL access — immediate
Legal hold: YES — 90 days minimum — do NOT delete
Notes: IT Security notified. Preserve all logs and mailbox content.
```

WHY FOR-CAUSE IS DIFFERENT

The moment I see 'FOR CAUSE' on a ticket, my first action is not to touch the account. My first action is to notify IT Security. Why? Because if this person is under investigation, the security team may need to capture forensic evidence from the account before I change anything. Disabling first could destroy evidence. Notification comes before action. Always.

TERM-0003 — Jessica Park — Contractor Expiry

Jessica was the IT Support Contractor I provisioned in Lab 01 with a 90-day account expiry. This ticket is the follow-up cleanup after AD automatically disabled her account on the expiry date. It's a

good example of why setting expiry dates on contractor accounts matters — the disable happened automatically without any human intervention.

```
TICKET #:       TERM-0003
Priority:       Scheduled
Date:           April 15, 2026
Requested by:   David Osei (IT Manager)

Contractor:     Jessica Park  |  Username: j.park.contractor
Department:     IT (Contractors OU)
Contract end:   90 days from Lab 01 provisioning

Action: Confirm auto-disable fired, complete cleanup, move to Disabled_Users
Legal hold: No  |  Retention: 30 days then delete
```

4. Pre-Offboarding Access Audit

Before I disabled anyone's account, I documented what access they currently had. This is your evidence baseline. If an auditor asks 'what did this person have access to at the time of termination?' you need to be able to answer that question precisely.

Here's what I found for each user before I touched anything:

Fatima Al-Hassan (f.alhassan)

What I checked	What I found	What needed to happen
AD Account	Active and enabled	Disable immediately
OU Location	Sales OU	Move to Disabled_Users after disable
Group memberships	GRP-Sales-Reps only	Remove from group
Any admin rights?	No	Nothing to do here
SalesPro CRM access	Active	Revoke
Email access	Active	Revoke
Legal hold required?	No	Set 30-day deletion reminder

Priya Sharma (p.sharma) — For Cause

What I checked	What I found	What needed to happen
IT Security notified?	Not yet	Notify BEFORE any changes
AD Account	Active	Disable — urgent

What I checked	What I found	What needed to happen
OU Location	HR OU	Move to Disabled_Users
Group memberships	GRP-HR-Coordinators	Remove
PeopleHub HR system access	Active	Revoke — priority
Any delegated permissions?	Checked — none found	Nothing extra to clean up
Activity logs status	Active	Preserve — do NOT clear
Legal hold required?	**YES**	Set 90-day hold
Mailbox content	Active	Preserve for Legal

5. How I Ran Each Offboarding

One thing I've learned is that the order of steps matters as much as the steps themselves. There's a reason disable always comes before group removal, and there's a reason IT Security gets notified before I touch anything on a for-cause termination. Let me walk through exactly what I did.

5.1 Fatima Al-Hassan — Standard Process

Straightforward execution. I had this done in under 20 minutes from ticket receipt to closure.

Step	What I did	Why
1	Verified the approval chain before starting	I never make changes without confirming HR + IT Director both signed off
2	Ran the pre-offboarding audit (table above)	So I know exactly what I'm revoking and have a before-state on record
3	Disabled f.alhassan in ADUC — first action	Cuts all active sessions immediately — nothing else happens until this is done
4	Removed from GRP-Sales-Reps	Member Of tab now shows only Domain Users — confirmed
5	Moved account to Disabled_Users OU	Keeps the account but separates it from active staff visually and for GPO purposes
6	Updated the account description	'TERMINATED April 15, 2026 — TERM-0001 — Delete after May 15, 2026'
7	Set a 30-day deletion calendar reminder	I can't rely on memory — the reminder ensures deletion doesn't get forgotten
8	Updated the provisioning log	Every action gets logged — this is the audit trail
9	Ran post-offboarding verification	Confirmed f.alhassan is in Disabled_Users with no remaining group memberships
10	Closed the ticket	TERM-0001 complete

5.2 Priya Sharma — For-Cause Process

More complex. More steps. More people involved. I slowed down deliberately here because the cost of a mistake on a for-cause termination is much higher than on a standard one.

Step	What I did	Why
1	Sent IT Security notification before touching anything	Policy violation case — Security may need forensic evidence. I don't move until they know.
2	Logged the CISO verbal approval with timestamp	For-cause terminations need this documented. Verbal approvals vanish if not written down.
3	Ran pre-offboarding audit	Same discipline as always — document the before-state
4	Disabled p.sharma — first account action	Cut all access immediately. Same rule as always, just with more urgency.
5	Removed from GRP-HR-Coordinators	Member Of tab shows only Domain Users
6	Audited for any delegated permissions	For-cause cases sometimes reveal access that wasn't in the original provisioning ticket
7	Moved to Disabled_Users OU	Account isolated from active staff
8	Updated description with FOR CAUSE and LEGAL HOLD flags	'TERMINATED April 15, 2026 — FOR CAUSE — LEGAL HOLD — Do NOT delete before July 14, 2026'
9	Set 90-day legal hold in the provisioning log	Standard terminations get 30 days. For-cause gets 90 — sometimes more if Legal requests it.
10	Set calendar reminder for July 9, 2026	The 85-day reminder gives me 5 days to contact Legal before the hold expires
11	Confirmed activity logs preserved with IT Security	Got written confirmation back — logged the response
12	Updated provisioning log with all actions and timestamps	Every step documented — this record may be needed in legal proceedings
13	Ran post-offboarding verification	Confirmed FOR CAUSE + LEGAL HOLD description is visible on the account
14	Closed ticket	TERM-0002 complete — IT Security confirmed receipt

5.3 Jessica Park — Contractor Expiry Cleanup

The easiest of the three because the hard part — the account disable — already happened automatically when the expiry date fired. This is exactly why setting expiry dates on contractor accounts matters. No human had to remember to do anything on the expiry date.

Step	What I did	Notes
1	Confirmed auto-disable fired correctly	Account was already disabled by AD — expiry mechanism worked as intended
2	Removed from GRP-IT-Contractors	Cleaned up the group membership manually

Step	What I did	Notes
3	Moved to Disabled_Users OU	From Contractors OU to Disabled_Users
4	Updated description	'CONTRACT EXPIRED — TERM-0003 — Delete after May 15, 2026'
5	Set 30-day deletion reminder	Calendar reminder set for May 15, 2026
6	Updated provisioning log	Contract expiry logged, auto-disable confirmed

6. What FictionalCorp Looks Like Now

After completing all three offboardings, here's the state of the environment. This is what I'd show during a post-offboarding verification or an access review.

Disabled_Users OU — Three accounts confirmed

Username	Name	Ticket	Type	Legal Hold	Delete Date
f.alhassan	Fatima Al-Hassan	TERM-0001	Resignation	No	May 15, 2026
p.sharma	Priya Sharma	TERM-0002	**FOR CAUSE**	YES — 90d	July 14, 2026
j.park.contractor	Jessica Park	TERM-0003	CONTRACT EXPIRED	No	May 15, 2026

Active staff — All unaffected

Username	Name	Department	Status
m.williams	Marcus Williams	Sales	Enabled
j.adeyemi	James Adeyemi	Sales	Enabled
l.okafor	Linda Okafor	HR	Enabled
a.chen	Alex Chen	Finance	Enabled
r.thompson	Rachel Thompson	Finance	Enabled
m.obi	Michael Obi	Finance	Enabled
d.osei	David Osei	IT	Enabled
k.nwosu	Karen Nwosu	IT	Enabled

7. The Offboarding Checklist

One of the most useful things that came out of this lab is a proper offboarding checklist. This is the kind of document that IAM teams actually use in production — something you run through on every termination to make sure nothing gets missed, even under time pressure.

I built it to cover both on-premises AD and Azure Entra ID. The Azure steps are placeholders for now — they get filled in during Lab 07 when Azure AD Connect is live. But having them in the checklist now means I'm thinking about hybrid offboarding from the start, not retrofitting it later.

Standard Employee Offboarding

Step	Action	On-Prem AD	Azure (from Lab 07)	Priority
1	Verify approval chain (HR + IT Director)	Required	Required	First — before anything else
2	Run pre-offboarding access audit	Required	Required	Before any changes
3	Disable AD account	Required	Syncs	**IMMEDIATE**
4	Revoke Entra ID active sessions	N/A	Required	IMMEDIATE — don't wait for sync
5	Remove from all AD security groups	Required	Syncs	Within 15 mins
6	Remove from distribution lists and shared mailboxes	Required	Required	Within 30 mins
7	Move account to Disabled_Users OU	Required	N/A	Within 30 mins
8	Update account description with ticket and dates	Required	N/A	Within 30 mins
9	Revoke application access (Okta, SalesPro, etc.)	N/A	Required	Within 60 mins
10	Remove Azure licenses	N/A	Required	Within 60 mins
11	Post-offboarding audit — confirm no residual access	Required	Required	Before closing
12	Set 30-day deletion calendar reminder	Required	N/A	Before closing
13	Update provisioning log with timestamps	Required	N/A	Last
14	Close ticket	Required	N/A	Last

Extra Steps for For-Cause Terminations

Step	Action	Why it matters
FC-1	Notify IT Security BEFORE touching the account	They may need forensic evidence before any changes are made
FC-2	Notify CISO and Legal — document even verbal approvals	For-cause cases can become legal matters. You need a paper trail from the start.
FC-3	Preserve all activity logs — no clearing, no purging	These logs may be evidence. Clearing them could obstruct an investigation.

Step	Action	Why it matters
FC-4	Set 90-day legal hold — NOT the standard 30-day retention	Legal proceedings take time. 30 days is not enough.
FC-5	Preserve mailbox content — no forwarding, no auto-reply	Emails are often the primary evidence in policy violation cases.
FC-6	Document every notification with name, time, and method	If this ends up in a hearing, you need to show exactly who knew what and when.
FC-7	Set 85-day legal hold review reminder — contact Legal before expiry	5 days buffer to confirm with Legal whether the hold can be lifted.

8. Something Most People Don't Talk About: The Hybrid Sync Gap

This is one of those things that doesn't get covered in most IAM training but comes up constantly in real hybrid environments. I want to document it properly because understanding this gap is what separates an IAM analyst who just follows a checklist from one who actually understands the security implications of their environment.

THE PROBLEM

Azure AD Connect syncs your on-premises Active Directory to Entra ID on a schedule. The default sync cycle is 30 minutes. That means when you disable an account in AD, the user's Entra ID account stays active for up to 30 minutes after you've disabled it on-prem.

During that window, the terminated employee can still:

- Access their email (Outlook, Teams)
- Access SharePoint and OneDrive
- Access any cloud applications assigned in Entra ID
- Download files, send emails, or cause damage

For a standard resignation this is an acceptable risk.
For a for-cause termination where someone has just been walked out of the building, this 30-minute window is a serious security exposure.

THE FIX — COMING IN LAB 07

When Azure AD Connect is configured in Lab 05, the Lab 07 hybrid offboarding process will add two manual steps that happen immediately — not on the sync schedule:

Step A: Disable in on-prem AD — immediate (done in this lab already)
Step B: Revoke all Entra ID sessions manually — immediate (Lab 07)
Step C: Remove Azure licenses — immediate (Lab 07)
Step D: Sync propagates the disable state — background (up to 30 mins)

> Steps B and C close the window completely. The user's cloud sessions are killed immediately without waiting for the sync cycle.

9. What I Learned From This Lab

A few things stood out for me during this lab that I want to make sure I remember going into interviews.

The order of steps isn't arbitrary

Disable first, then clean up. This order protects you. If you start removing group memberships before disabling the account, there's a window where the user still has an active session but is slowly losing access — which could actually alert them to what's happening before you've completed the revocation. Disable cuts everything at once.

Documentation is the job, not a side effect of the job

I used to think logging actions was administrative overhead. It's not. The provisioning log, the account description, the audit trail — these are the deliverables that prove the work was done correctly. If an auditor asks about a termination from six months ago, the log is the only thing that answers their question reliably.

For-cause terminations are a different discipline entirely

The technical steps are largely the same. The professional discipline around them is completely different. Notifications, evidence preservation, legal hold, verbal approval documentation — these don't come naturally unless you've thought through why each one exists. Now I have.

The contractor expiry pattern is elegant

Setting an account expiry at provisioning time and letting AD handle the disable automatically is a small but powerful design choice. It removes human error from the equation entirely. Jessica's account disabled itself on the right day without anyone having to remember to do it. That's the kind of thinking that impresses security-conscious organizations.

10. How I Would Talk About This in an Interview

WHEN THEY ASK: WHAT IS YOUR OFFBOARDING PROCESS?

I'd say something like this:

When a termination ticket comes in, the first thing I do is verify the approval chain. I need HR, the manager, and IT Director all confirmed before I touch anything. Then I run a quick pre-offboarding audit so I know exactly what access the person has before I make any changes — that becomes my evidence baseline.

My first action in AD is always to disable the account. Not remove groups, not move OUs — disable first. That cuts all active sessions immediately. Then I remove group memberships, move to our Disabled_Users OU, update the account description with the ticket reference and deletion date, and set a calendar reminder so the deletion actually happens 30 days later.

In a hybrid environment I also immediately revoke Entra ID sessions manually, because the AD sync can take up to 30 minutes and I can't leave that window open for a terminated employee. Every step gets timestamped in our offboarding audit log.

WHEN THEY ASK: WHAT'S DIFFERENT ABOUT A FOR-CAUSE TERMINATION?

I'd say:

The biggest difference is that I don't touch the account first. I notify IT Security before making any changes, because if the person is under investigation, the security team may need to capture forensic evidence from the account in its current state.

After that, the technical steps are similar but with a higher threshold for documentation. I set a 90-day legal hold instead of 30 days, preserve mailbox content for Legal, document every notification with timestamps, and set an 85-day review reminder so Legal has 5 days to confirm whether the hold can be lifted before the date arrives.

The discipline around for-cause terminations is mostly about protecting the organization legally, not just closing off access technically.

11. Portfolio Screenshots

These screenshots are stored in the Lab03_Portfolio folder and uploaded to GitHub under /Lab03-Offboarding/Screenshots/.

#	What the screenshot shows	Why I captured it
1	Disabled_Users OU with all 3 terminated accounts visible	Shows the completed offboarding state at a glance

#	What the screenshot shows	Why I captured it
2	f.alhassan — General tab with TERM-0001 description and dates	Proves the audit trail is in the account itself
3	f.alhassan — Member Of tab showing only Domain Users	Confirms group removal was complete
4	p.sharma — General tab with FOR CAUSE and LEGAL HOLD description	Documents the for-cause handling and retention requirement
5	p.sharma — Member Of tab showing only Domain Users	Confirms HR Coordinator group was removed
6	Offboarding checklist — standard and for-cause sections	Shows the governance document I built from this lab
7	Offboarding audit log with timestamps for all 3 terminations	The compliance artifact showing what was done and when

12. What I Produced

Deliverable	Where it lives	Status
Offboarding checklist (standard + for-cause)	/Lab03-Offboarding/	Done ✓
Pre-offboarding access audits	/Lab03-Offboarding/	Done ✓
Offboarding audit log — all 3 tickets	/Lab03-Offboarding/	Done ✓
Provisioning log updated	/Docs/	Done ✓
Lab 03 screenshots (x7)	/Lab03-Offboarding/Screenshots/	Done ✓
This documentation	/Lab03-Offboarding/	Done ✓

13. What Comes Next

LAB 04 — ACCOUNT LOCKOUT INVESTIGATION USING EVENT VIEWER

Lab 04 is all about troubleshooting — the most common daily ticket an IAM analyst gets. Account lockouts happen constantly in enterprise environments and knowing how to trace one back to its source quickly is a skill that gets noticed.

I'll be working with Event IDs 4740, 4625, and 4648 in Windows Event Viewer on DC01, writing a Root Cause Analysis report, and doing a side-by-side comparison between on-prem Event Viewer and Entra ID Sign-in Logs to show how the same event looks across both environments.

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https://github.com/okpe027/IAM-HomeLab-Portfolio